Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 4 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Light drizzle	Overcast	Overcast
11° 8°	10° 7°	12° 9°	11° 6°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **Some positive news for UK businesses and consumers, as a draft deal has been agreed to scrap Brexit red tape on food exports.**

This is being hailed as the most significant part of the 'Brexit reset' agreed so far, ahead of a UK-EU summit later this month. It aims to reduce bureaucracy and make exporting food much smoother.

POLITICS · UK

2 **The King has called the slave trade a 'shameful chapter' in history during a Commonwealth address.**

His speech follows increasing calls for the UK government to issue a formal apology for Britain's historical role in the trade. The comments were made as part of his ongoing commitment to the Commonwealth nations.

ROYALS · UK

3 **The UK meat industry has been hit by a cyber-attack that also targeted supermarket freezers across Europe.**

Supermarkets in several countries, including Ireland, Sweden, and Belgium, reported that their fridge temperatures were hiked on Monday. Investigations are now underway into the extent of the attack and who was responsible.

TECHNOLOGY · UK

4 **A Reform UK councillor has been charged with multiple serious offences, including rape and sexual assault.**

George Madgwick faces 35 charges, including 12 counts of rape, following an investigation. The Crown Prosecution Service has confirmed the charges.

CRIME · UK

5 **A major study has been launched in the UK to investigate 'forever chemicals' found in people's bodies.**

This is the first study of its kind to measure PFAS (per- and polyfluoroalkyl substances) in the UK population. The government hopes to better understand the potential risks these chemicals pose to public health.

HEALTH · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Could we have a new James Bond on our hands? 'The Crown' star Josh O'Connor has reacted to the rumours.**

The BAFTA-nominated actor says he's 'honoured' by the speculation that he could be the next 007. Fans have been eagerly awaiting news on who will take over the iconic role.

ON AIR — Who would you like to see as the next James Bond?

FILM · COMING SOON

2 **Bollywood film star Ranbir Kapoor is making waves with his thoughts on AI, movies, and fatherhood.**

Kapoor is starring in a major new adaptation of the Indian epic 'Ramayana'. He's been discussing how artificial intelligence might impact the film industry and his personal life.

ON AIR — Do you think AI will change the way we watch movies?

FILM · FUTURE

3 **Fans of David Bowie will be thrilled to hear about a new exhibition celebrating his Scottish links.**

Hundreds of items from Bowie's personal archive are set to go on display at the V&A in Dundee. It promises a fascinating insight into the legendary musician's life and career.

ON AIR — What's your favourite David Bowie song?

EXHIBITION · SOON

4 **Alton Towers has announced the closure of its 'World of David Walliams' attraction.**

The theme park stated that the closure follows a 'regular review of rides and attractions'. It means the end for rides like 'Gangsta Granny: The Ride' and other Walliams-themed experiences.

ON AIR — Have you ever been to the World of David Walliams at Alton Towers? What was your favourite part?

THEME PARK · SOON

5 **Collins Dictionary has announced its word of the year... but do you know what 'mogging' means?**

The slang term, which relates to outshining or upstaging someone, is one of ten words celebrated by the dictionary. It's a sign of how language is constantly evolving.

ON AIR — Have you heard of 'mogging' before? What's your favourite new word?

LANGUAGE · NOW

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **West Ham United have sacked head coach Nuno Espirito Santo and are reportedly in talks with Scott Parker as his replacement.**

The club made the announcement following a disappointing run of results. Fans will be eager to see who takes the helm next and what changes they might bring.

ON AIR — Do you think Scott Parker is the right choice for West Ham?

FOOTBALL · UK

2 **William Saliba is back in first-team training for Arsenal, giving Mikel Arteta a defensive dilemma ahead of their Champions League game.**

Saliba's return is a huge boost for the club, but it now presents Arteta with a selection headache. Arsenal face Slavia Prague in the Champions League.

ON AIR — Who should Mikel Arteta pick in his defence for the Champions League match?

FOOTBALL · UK

3 **The Lionesses will face France and Portugal in next year's Women's Nations League.**

England have been drawn into a tough group, also including Austria. It promises to be an exciting competition as they look to build on recent successes.

ON AIR — How do you rate the Lionesses' chances in the Nations League group?

FOOTBALL · UK

4 **England have secured their place in the Wheelchair Rugby League World Cup semi-finals after a dominant victory over the USA.**

They scored 23 tries in a huge 134-0 win, booking their spot with a group match still to play. It's an incredible performance from the team.

ON AIR — Are you following the Wheelchair Rugby League World Cup? What do you think of England's performance so far?

RUGBY LEAGUE · UK

5 **A horse sold by King Charles has won Australia's famous Melbourne Cup.**

Point of Law, ridden by Ethan Brown, claimed victory in the race known as 'the race that stops a nation'. It's a royal connection to one of the biggest events in horse racing.

ON AIR — Did you know King Charles was involved in horse racing? Have you ever had a flutter on the Melbourne Cup?

HORSE RACING · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1. **A surprising new survey reveals that many of us are finding joy in the quiet satisfaction of perfectly folding a fitted sheet.**
   It seems the once-daunting laundry task is now a source of small triumph, with participants reporting a noticeable mood boost after achieving the elusive neat fold.

2. **The gentle art of 'rewatching old home videos' is experiencing a resurgence, as people seek comfort in nostalgic moments.**
   Families are gathering to relive cherished memories, with many discovering forgotten details and rediscovering the simple joys of the past.

3. **Researchers have noted a growing appreciation for the specific 'click and clack' sound of a well-used keyboard.**
   Far from being a distraction, the rhythmic typing sounds are being described as a comforting background noise, especially for those working from home.

4. **A new trend sees individuals taking up the surprisingly engaging hobby of 'arranging coins by date and origin'.**
   What starts as a simple sorting task often turns into a fascinating exploration of history and geography, all from loose change.

5. **Experts are suggesting that the subtle 'fragrance of freshly printed paper' is offering a unique form of sensory pleasure.**
   From new books to office printouts, the distinct scent is being enjoyed as a momentary, pleasant break in our busy days.

6. **The simple pleasure of 'finding the perfect spot for a new picture or ornament' in the home is bringing unexpected delight.**
   It's not just about decorating; it's the satisfying feeling of creating harmony and balance in a beloved living space.

7. **Many are discovering the unexpected fun in 'identifying different types of biscuits purely by their crumbs'.**
   What started as a playful family game is now a recognised skill amongst snack enthusiasts, proving that even crumbs can bring joy.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 65% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if a new type of cheese in the supermarket will be good, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GENTLY SMELLING IT RIGHT THROUGH THE PACKAGING!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd ritual' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new bar of chocolate, especially if it's a fancy, artisan kind. What is it?**

ANSWER: BREAKING OFF A TINY PIECE AND LETTING IT MELT ON THE TONGUE BEFORE EATING THE REST!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes you discover a new 'sound' in your daily life that you hadn't really noticed before, but now you find it strangely comforting or interesting?**
  Perhaps it's the hum of a specific appliance, the distant train, or even a particular bird call. What's a new everyday sound you've recently 'discovered' and grown to appreciate?

- **We all have those little 'secret talents' or quirky skills that only a few people know about, or perhaps nobody at all!**
  Maybe you can perfectly stack tins, or you're a master at pebble skimming. What's your slightly unusual or niche skill that you're secretly quite proud of?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Space.** There are more stars in the universe than grains of sand on all the beaches on Earth.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The Great Wall of China is the only man-made structure visible from the Moon with the naked eye.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£25 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£3.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- A group of rhinos is called a 'crash'.
- Bubble wrap was originally intended to be used as wallpaper.
- The shortest war in history was between Britain and Zanzibar on August 27, 1896, lasting only 38 minutes.
- Mars is known as the 'Red Planet' due to iron oxide on its surface, which is the same compound that makes blood and rust red.
- The 'sixth sick sheik's sixth sheep's sick' is believed to be the toughest tongue twister in the English language.
- The average person walks the equivalent of five times around the world in their lifetime.
- The inventor of the frisbee was turned into a frisbee after he died.
- Mount Everest grows by approximately 4 millimetres each year due to geological activity.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES WED 4 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 308 of the year, 57 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles Borromeo (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Emeric of Hungary; Christian feast day: Felix of Valois; Christian feast day: Blessed Françoise d'Amboise. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1918 — Art Carney, American actor (died 2003)
- 1970 — Tony Sly, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2012)
- 1915 — Marguerite Patten, English economist and author (died 2015)
- 1956 — James Honeyman-Scott, English guitarist and songwriter (died 1982)
- 1919 — Martin Balsam, American actor, director, and screenwriter (died 1996)
- 1925 — Doris Roberts, American actress (died 2016)
- 1963 — Lena Zavaroni, Scottish singer and television host (died 1999)
- 1980 — Emme Rylan, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1942 — World War II: Disobeying a direct order by Adolf Hitler, General Field Marshal Erwin Rommel begins a retreat of his forces after a costly defeat during the Second Battle of El Alamein. The retreat would ultimately last five months.
- 1956 — Soviet troops enter Hungary to end the Hungarian revolution against the Soviet Union that started on October 23. Thousands are killed, more are wounded, and nearly a quarter million leave the country.
- 1970 — Vietnam War: The United States turns over control of the air base at Bình Thủy in the Mekong Delta to South Vietnam.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1993 — China Airlines Flight 605, a brand-new 747-400, overruns the runway at Hong Kong Kai Tak Airport.
- 1962 — The United States concludes Operation Fishbowl, its final above-ground nuclear weapons testing series, in anticipation of the 1963 Partial Nuclear Test Ban Treaty.

TODAY IN HISTORY

- 1970 — Vietnam War: The United States turns over control of the air base at Bình Thủy in the Mekong Delta to South Vietnam.

- 1942 — World War II: Disobeying a direct order by Adolf Hitler, General Field Marshal Erwin Rommel begins a retreat of his forces after a costly defeat during the Second Battle of El Alamein. The retreat would ultimately last five months.
- 2022 — The Khash massacre, which refers to the repression of protesters by Iranian security forces, resulting in 18 deaths and more than 20 injuries.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES THU 5 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 309 of the year, 56 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: All Jesuit Saints and Blesseds; Christian feast day: Saint Domninus of Grenoble; Christian feast day: Blessed Bernhard Lichtenberg; Christian feast day: Berthild of Chelles. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Lisa Scott-Lee, Welsh singer-songwriter
- 1971 — Jonny Greenwood, English guitarist and songwriter
- 1969 — Pat Kilbane, American actor, comedian, director and screenwriter
- 1937 — Harris Yulin, American actor (died 2025)
- 1974 — Ryan Adams, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1949 — Jimmie Spheeris, American singer-songwriter (died 1984)
- 1958 — Don Falcone, American keyboard player, songwriter and producer
- 1958 — Mo Gaffney, American actress and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1990 — Rabbi Meir Kahane, founder of the far-right Kach movement, is shot dead after a speech at a New York City hotel.
- 2015 — Rona Ambrose takes over after Stephen Harper as the Leader of the Conservative Party of Canada.
- 1995 — André Dallaire attempts to assassinate Prime Minister Jean Chrétien of Canada. He is thwarted when the Prime Minister's wife locks the door.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2006 — Saddam Hussein, the former president of Iraq, and his co-defendants Barzan Ibrahim al-Tikriti and Awad Hamed al-Bandar, are sentenced to death in the al-Dujail trial for their roles in the 1982 massacre of 148 Shia Muslims.
- 1970 — The Military Assistance Command, Vietnam reports the lowest weekly American soldier death toll in five years (24).

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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